QR-015 Buying something and getting paid back

Doc ID	QR-015
Title	Buying something and getting paid back
Parent	CS-012 §7.1; CS-012 §7.2; CS-012 §7.9; CS-012 §4; CS-012 §6; CS-012 §7.4; CS-012 §7.5; CS-012 §7.7; CS-012 §1; CS-012 §7.3; CS-011 §7.2
Checked against	CS-012 Rev G; CS-012 Rev G; CS-012 Rev G; CS-012 Rev G; CS-012 Rev G; CS-012 Rev G; CS-012 Rev G; CS-012 Rev G; CS-012 Rev G; CS-011 Rev E

Derived from its parent standard. If this and the parent disagree, the parent is right. Names, tiers and channels are as of 2026-10-07 and are re-checked each season (CS-012 §7).

1. How do I get a purchase approved before I buy?

Run `/purchase` in #purchasing-slackbot with the budget reference ID, the amount and the reason, and buy only after the bot's approval DM arrives (CS-012 §7.1). For several items on different reference IDs, use `/bigorder`.

Also called: approval, approve, pre-approval, permission to buy, purchase request, /purchase, /bigorder, purchasing bot, Flux, #purchasing, #purchasing-slackbot, can I buy.

1. Pick the reference ID for the budget line that pays; `/reference` lists them (QR-015 §3).
2. Run `/purchase` in #purchasing-slackbot with the reference ID, the amount and the reason.
3. Wait. The bot sends the request to the approver for its amount: under $50 the subteam lead, $50 to $250 the division lead, over $250 the President or VP (CS-012 §4; QR-015 §2).
4. Buy only after the approval DM arrives.
5. Log it in the Budget tab and write the bot's REQ number in the purchase's Notes (CS-012 §7.9; QR-015 §7).

- #purchasing was retired on 2026-10-07. Requests go through the Flux bot in #purchasing-slackbot now (CS-012 Rev G history).
- Treat a purchase not logged in #purchasing-slackbot as not reimbursed (CS-012 §7.7 step 2).

2. Who approves my purchase?

By amount: under $50 the subteam lead, $50 to $250 the division lead, over $250 the President or VP (CS-012 §4, §7.1 step 2). The purchasing bot routes the request to the right one.

Also called: approval tiers, approver, who approves, spending limit, how much can I spend, subteam lead, division lead, President, VP.

Amount	Approver
Under $50	Subteam lead
$50 to $250	Division lead
Over $250	President or VP

- A purchase under $50 still needs the subteam lead's approval. The app does not flag it (CS-012 §7.1).
- The Budget tab counts purchases over $50 whose Reimbursement is still Submitted, as "Over $50, unapproved" (CS-012 §7.1).
- The tiers were re-verified on 2026-10-07 and are unchanged (CS-012 Rev G history).

3. Which reference ID do I use?

The one for the budget line the money comes from: `/reference` lists them, and composites lines start `COMP-`. Testing purchases use `TRAN-012`. Use a `-000` ID only for something the budget never listed, and tell the lead (CS-012 §7.2 step 4).

Also called: reference ID, budget line, budget code, account, category, COMP-, TRAN-012, TRAN-002, -000, /reference, which code.

- A reference ID looks like `COMP-011` (CS-012 §4).
- A `-000` ID comes out of another line, which is why the lead needs to know (CS-012 §7.2 step 4).
- If the money is not composites', write the reference ID in the purchase's Charged to field, for example `TRAN-002` for RFS consumables. Leave Charged to blank for a `COMP-` line (CS-012 §7.9 step 3).
- Charged to blank, or "Composites", means it counts against the composites season total. Anything else is still tracked and still reimbursed, but not counted there (CS-012 §4).

4. How do I get reimbursed?

Log the purchase in the bot and submit it within one month of buying, with `/reimburse`, the reference ID and the amount (CS-012 §7.2 step 5). You need the itemized receipt and the card statement line.

Also called: reimburse, reimbursed, reimbursement, paid back, pay me back, get my money back, /reimburse, expense, refund.

1. Photograph the itemized receipt, or save the PDF invoice an online order emails you (CS-012 §7.2 step 1).
2. Add the card statement, with other lines redacted (CS-012 §7.2 step 2; QR-015 §5).
3. Amazon: wait until the order shows Shipped or Delivered.
4. Pick the reference ID (QR-015 §3).
5. Submit within one month of the purchase with `/reimburse`, the reference ID and the amount.
6. Attach the receipt to the purchase in the Budget tab with + Add / scan receipt. Put the quote and order confirmation under Other files.
7. To use Fill from receipt, press Edit first, then check every line it proposes (CS-012 §7.2 step 7; QR-015 §8).
8. Move Reimbursement to Reimbursed when the money arrives (QR-015 §9).

- Deposits take up to a month (CS-012 §6).
- Season close has a hard finance deadline; SN5's was July 4 (CS-012 §7.7 step 1; QR-015 §12).

5. What does the receipt need to show?

An itemized receipt, or the PDF invoice for an online order, plus the card statement line. A card statement alone is not enough (CS-012 §7.2 steps 1 and 2).

Also called: receipt, invoice, itemized receipt, itemised receipt, card statement, bank statement, proof of purchase, order confirmation, redact.

- The receipt or invoice: itemized, so each thing bought is listed.
- The card statement: redact the other lines, but keep your name, address, the card's last 4 digits, the purchase and the date (CS-012 §7.2 step 2).
- Amazon orders must show Shipped or Delivered before you submit (CS-012 §7.2 step 3).
- Attach the receipt to the purchase in the Budget tab with + Add / scan receipt, and the quote and order confirmation under Other files (CS-012 §7.2 step 6).

6. Which payment methods are not reimbursed?

Cash, Venmo, Zelle and PayPal are not reimbursed. Ask the finance lead before paying with one. Gift cards: ask the finance lead first, because the 2025 rules excluded them (CS-012 §7.2 step 5).

Also called: payment method, how to pay, cash, Venmo, Zelle, PayPal, gift card, personal card, credit card, debit card, fronting money.

- Nobody fronts more than they are comfortable waiting about a month to get back. Deposits take up to a month (CS-012 §6).
- A lead names 2 to 3 regular purchasers, with the finance lead's knowledge, so no single card is the team's float (CS-012 §7.3).
- In SN5 almost all of the spend went through the lead's personal card (CS-012 §1).

7. How do I log a purchase in the app's Budget tab?

Press + New Purchase in Budget when you make the `/purchase` request; the app gives it a `BUY-SN6-###` ID. Fill Item, Purchaser, Purpose, Cost ($) and Source / vendor, and put the bot's REQ number in Notes (CS-012 §7.9).

Also called: Budget tab, log a purchase, New Purchase, BUY, purchase record, line items, + Line, Notes, REQ number, Charged to.

1. Press + New Purchase in Budget.
2. Fill Item, Purchaser, Purpose, Cost ($) and Source / vendor.
3. Write the bot's REQ number in Notes, for example `REQ-000064`.
4. If the money is not composites', write the reference ID in Charged to. Leave it blank for a `COMP-` line.
5. Press Edit, then add Line items with + Line, one per thing that will go on a shelf, with the total and count as the receipt prints them.
6. Attach the receipt with + Add / scan receipt when you have it.
7. Move Order status and Reimbursement as the purchase moves (QR-015 §9).

Every purchase should be logged here: Inventory's Incoming list, the Running out card's "on order" and a received lot's link back to its purchase all read from it (CS-012 §7.9).

8. What does Fill from receipt do, and do I have to check it?

It reads the attached receipt into editable line items. Yes: check every line it proposes against the receipt before you leave the page. Anything a button fills is a draft until a person checks it (CS-012 §7.2 step 7, CS-014 §7.4).

Also called: Fill from receipt, , sparkle button, AI, AI read, scan receipt, read the receipt, auto-fill, line items.

1. Attach the receipt first with + Add / scan receipt. The button reads that.
2. Press Edit, then Fill from receipt (shown when a lead has AI features on).
3. If the purchase already has line items, the app asks whether to add what the receipt says underneath them.
4. Read each proposed line against the paper or PDF receipt.
5. Fix or delete any line that is wrong.
6. If the app warns that the lines add up to a different total than the receipt prints, look for a missing line.

The lines feed the Incoming list and receiving (CS-012 §7.9), so a wrong line becomes a wrong record on a shelf.

9. Order status and Reimbursement: what do the statuses mean?

The Budget tab follows one purchase on two tracks. Order status is the goods: Submitted, Purchased, Arrived. Reimbursement is the money: Submitted, Approved, Reimbursed (CS-012 §7.1).

Also called: status, Order status, Reimbursement status, Submitted, Purchased, Arrived, Approved, Reimbursed, tracking, two tracks.

+ New Purchase on the Budget tab makes `BUY-SN6-###`.
Write the bot's `REQ` number in Notes.

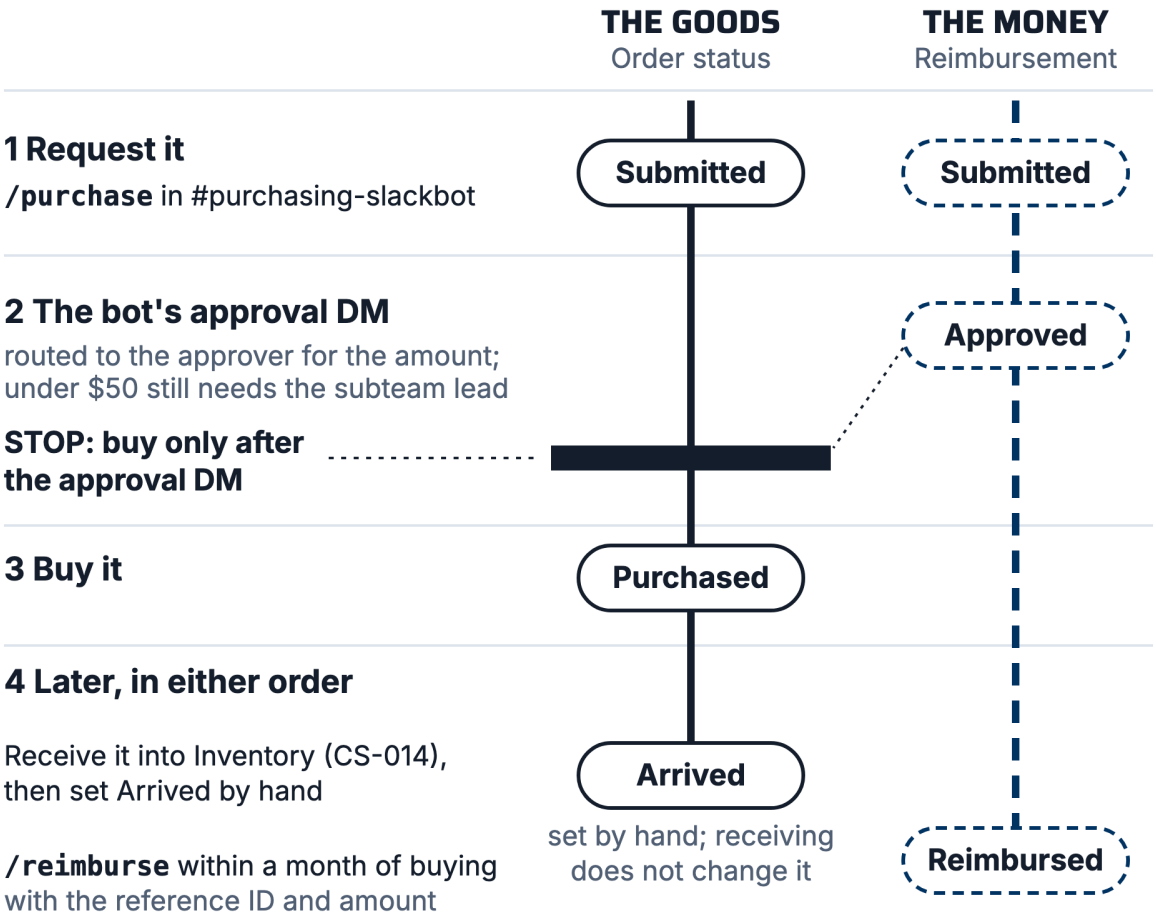


Figure 1: One purchase on two tracks: the goods and the money

Track	Status	Means
Order status (the goods)	Submitted	Requested in the bot, not bought yet
Order status (the goods)	Purchased	Bought, after the approval DM
Order status (the goods)	Arrived	Here and received into Inventory. Set it by hand; receiving does not change it
Reimbursement (the money)	Submitted	Owed to the purchaser
Reimbursement (the money)	Approved	The bot's approval DM came back
Reimbursement (the money)	Reimbursed	Paid back

- Receiving the goods into Inventory is CS-014; it is QR-006.
- "Over $50, unapproved" counts purchases over $50 whose Reimbursement is still Submitted (CS-012 §7.1).

10. Rush orders and expensive shipping

An order whose shipping costs more than twice the items needs the lead's sign-off before you buy, with the alternative stated: wait, borrow or buy locally (CS-012 §7.5). The lead writes the sign-off and the alternative in the purchase's Notes.

Also called: rush order, rush shipping, express, overnight, expedited, expensive shipping, shipping cost, next day.

1. Compare the shipping to the cost of the items.
2. If shipping is more than twice the items, stop and ask the lead.
3. Say what the alternative is: wait, borrow or buy locally.
4. The lead writes the sign-off and the alternative considered in the purchase's Notes.

In SN5, $400 of shipping went on $120 of ACP rods (CS-012 §1, PP-08). Ordering early is the fix: Easy Composites orders go in at least 6 weeks before the material is needed (CS-012 §7.4 step 1).

11. When to order resin and cloth: restock and the Easy Composites basket

Order at least 6 weeks before you need it: bulk consumables and the first Easy Composites basket in September, the spring basket in December, and anything the stock walk finds at or below its minimum (CS-012 §7.4 steps 1 to 3; CS-011 §7.2 step 1).

Also called: when to order, when should I order, restock, reorder, basket, Easy Composites order, EC order, bulk order, order calendar, Running out, lead time.

Before each Easy Composites order the lead presses + New Purchase in Budget and sets Purpose to Restock (if budget goals are set, Purpose lists the goal categories: pick the one restocks are charged to); members add their wants as Line items with + Line (CS-012 §7.4 step 4). The Running out card's Add N to a purchase adds the reorders.

1. In September, order bulk consumables and the first Easy Composites basket, at least 6 weeks ahead plus a customs margin (CS-012 §7.4 step 1).
2. In December, order the spring-semester basket.
3. Through the season, order what the CS-011 stock walk finds at or below its minimum.
4. On the Running out card, press Add N to a purchase and pick the Restock purchase under Add to (CS-012 §7.4 step 5).
5. When the basket closes, post it with `/bigorder` or `/purchase` (CS-012 §7.4 step 6).

12. Season close: when is the reimbursement deadline?

Submit every reimbursement by the finance deadline at season close. SN5's was a July 4 hard cutoff, with an escalation window to July 14; the dates change yearly, so check #purchasing-slackbot (CS-012 §7.7 step 1).

Also called: season close, deadline, cutoff, end of season, last day to reimburse, July.

Each purchase is also due within one month of buying: submit it with `/reimburse`, the reference ID and the amount (CS-012 §7.2 step 5). Treat a purchase not logged in #purchasing-slackbot as not reimbursed (CS-012 §7.7 step 2).